

FIREFIGHTING

Urgency will always exist.

How to leave urgency mode and start planning again.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

The problem is when it takes the time that should be killing the cause.

THE CASCADE

The wheel that turns by itself.

WHAT YOU SEE

Urgency arrives with a deadline and noise...

THE MECHANISM

...thinking time has no deadline, so it gives way...

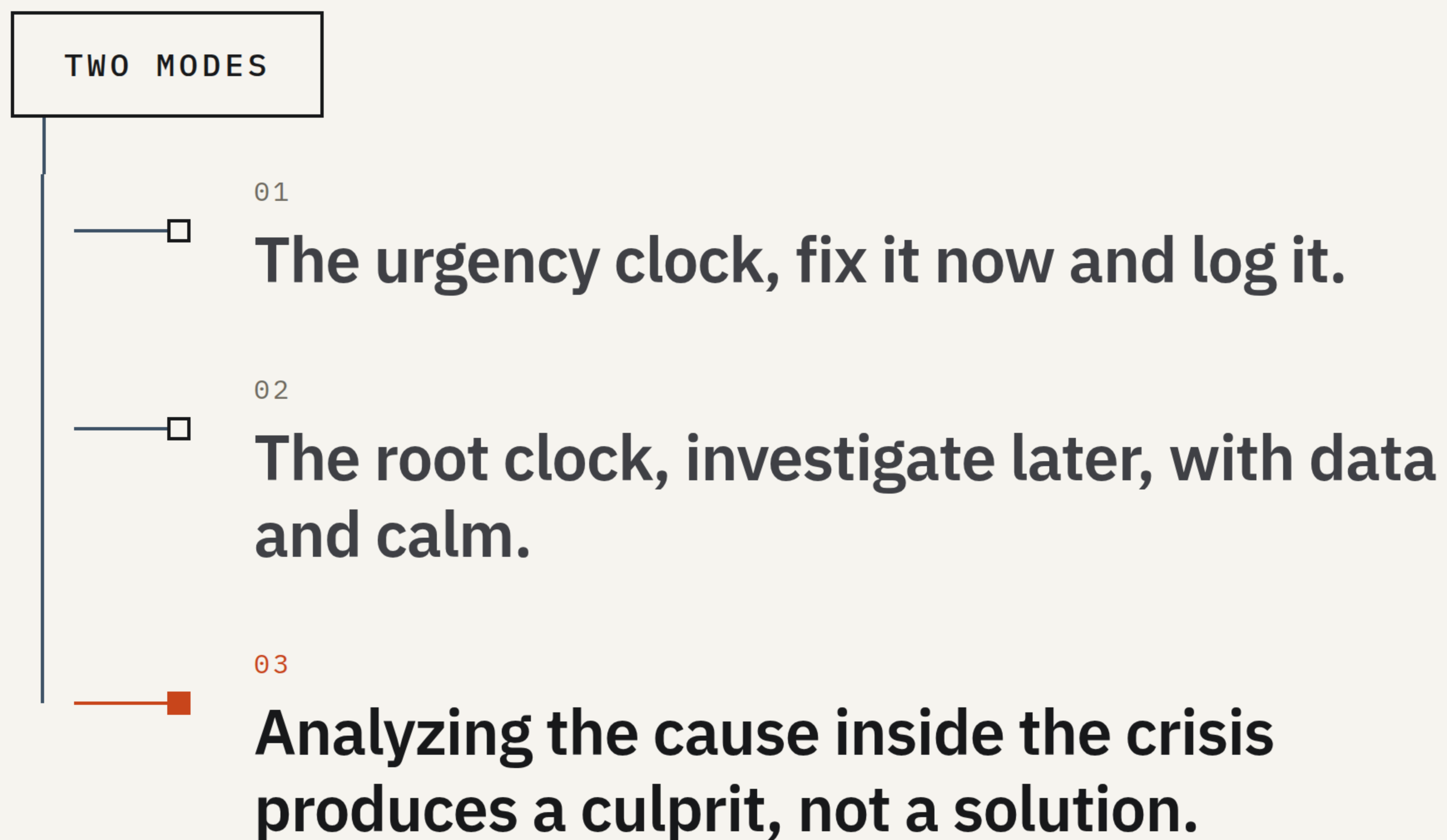
THE CONSEQUENCE

...and the same problem comes back next month, bigger.

What has no deadline always loses to what shouts. That is why it needs a block.

THE FORK

Two modes that do not mix.



| In the heat of the problem you repair. Outside it you eliminate.

THE METHOD

How to start the second clock.



01 BLOCK THE TIME

two fixed hours a week, out of the room and uninterrupted

02 PICK THE COSTLIEST

the fire that repeated most or cost most this month

03 FIND THE ROOT

with data, how many times, at what stage, waiting on what, costing how much

04 OWNER AND DATE

a fix with no owner is venting with the word plan on it

Two hours a week. In one quarter that is twelve fires eliminated.

IN PRACTICE, IN ORDER

Four defenses against your own urgency.

01 • BLOCK THE
TIME

Out of the room and no notifications.

half an hour interrupted yields less than ten uninterrupted minutes

02 • PICK THE
COSTLIEST

Someone covering the desk.

agree who answers during your block, and give them the ceiling

03 • FIND THE
ROOT

Data prepared beforehand.

with no number on the table, the block becomes an opinion session

04 • OWNER AND
DATE

Same hour every week.

a movable block is a cancelled block, always, no exceptions

TWO MODELS

On call technician or architect.

THE COMMON MODEL

On call technician

The calendar is written by other people

Fixes the same case every month

Knows who failed

Ends the year exhausted and in the same place

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Architect

Reserves time for the cause

Eliminates one problem a week

Knows where the design fails

Ends the year with less fire

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three comfortable traps.

01 Enjoying the adrenaline of fixing.

- firefighting pays out fast, planning pays out nothing at all.

02 Being recognized for saving the day.

- the company applauds whoever puts it out, rarely whoever prevented it.

03 Never logging what happened.

- with no record, the pattern never emerges and everything looks new.

If firefighting became your identity, planning will feel like idleness.

THE CHAIN

The blank calendar test.

01

Open your last week and look at every block.



02

How many had no fire involved at all?



03

If the answer is zero, you are on call, not managing.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

A week with no root block is a week that will repeat itself.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

Two hours to start the turn.



STEP 01

Write down the fires of the last four weeks.

just the name and the date, the pattern shows on the second read



STEP 02

Mark the most expensive and the most repeated.

it is almost always the same one, and nobody had noticed



STEP 03

Block two fixed hours to attack its root.

with an owner, a date and a simple way to know it is gone

Planning is not the opposite of executing. It is what stops execution repeating itself.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Second Clock, in the order that matters.



Whoever only fights fires guarantees next month's fire.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER

in the next week when everything looks urgent.

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MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA